

Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree, currently an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto and previously in rail operations planning at Metrolinx. Writes the briefing notes, memos and presentations senior staff decide from, builds KPI reporting, and coordinates across stakeholders whose interests conflict.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Write the briefing notes, memos and presentations that carry findings and recommendations to managers across divisions.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, replacing a report rebuilt by hand with one validated source that tracks divisional performance continuously.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and put positions in writing that hold up with each of them.
- Review development applications and engineering submissions against City standards, and flag where they fall short.
- Run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, holding the schedule and quality myself.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Substantiated the effect of proposed operating changes on run times, equipment and schedule, using OpenTrack simulation of GO rail services.
- Put the evidence in front of schedulers, operations staff and engineers, and worked with them to settle what a service plan had to be built on.
- Analysed run-time and speed profile patterns across subdivisions to find where schedules were most exposed to variance.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Briefing notes, memos and presentations for senior audiences. KPIs, dashboards and performance reporting. MS Office, including large multi-source Excel workbooks. Python (Pandas, NumPy) and SQL. Stakeholder coordination and consensus building. OpenTrack rail simulation.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)